



A MAN DESTINED TO BECOME MASTER OF THE STATE

MINAMOTO YORITOMO BECOMES SHOGUN (1192)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Shogunate Japan

BEFORE

1087 The *Insei* system begins: emperors withdraw from court but retain authority, in order to counter the power of regents and the rising warrior class.

1156 The Minamoto challenge the Taira for the first time, and are crushed.

1180 The Genpei War between the Minamoto and the Taira breaks out.

1190s Minamoto Yoritomo builds power in the provinces.

AFTER

1221 Emperor Go-Toba fails to reestablish imperial power in the Jōkyū Disturbance.

1333 The Ashikaga family overthrows the Kamakura shogunate.

1467 The Ōnin Wars, the first of a series that plague Japan for over a century, break out.

When in 1192 the Japanese clan leader Minamoto Yoritomo became the military commander-in-chief, or shogun, it marked the ascent to power of a Japanese military class, the samurai, and established a line of

The **imperial court** at Kyoto becomes inward-looking and **loses touch with the provinces.**



Lawlessness in the provinces leads to the rise of the **samurai** military class.



After victory over the Taira, Minamoto Yoritomo is appointed shogun.



Samurai clans become semi-independent as **shogunate authority weakens.**



The shogunate collapses and **power devolves to the daimyo.**

military rulers who would govern Japan for the next 750 years.

The Japanese imperial court had been dominated since the mid-7th century by regents from the Fujiwara family, who had reduced the emperors to mere figureheads. The situation became entrenched after the capital moved (following the emperor) to Kyoto in 794. Non-Fujiwara nobles were denied preferment at court, so sought positions in the provinces. The gulf widened between